Mainstream Consciousness Discourse as Lexical Disambiguation Failure

A Disambiguation-First Methodological Hypothesis

Disambiguation does not solve consciousness, prove that distinct senses name distinct phenomena, or eliminate genuine theoretical conflict.

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Abstract

The term *consciousness* is used for partially overlapping targets: subjective experience, wakeful state, cognitive access, reportability, metacognition, functional organization, self-modeling, and forms of meaning or stake participation. When a discussion shifts among these targets without notice, apparent disagreements can be produced by lexical equivocation or invalid transfer of properties across domains.

This paper develops lexical disambiguation failure as a diagnostic hypothesis rather than a verdict on the field. It proposes that consciousness claims be represented through an explicit term, sense, target, domain, transformation set, invariant or predicate, operational indicator, evidence basis, and cross-domain mapping. Claims can then be classified as well-formed, underspecified, equivocal, mapped, substantively disputed, or empirically unresolved.

Disambiguation does not solve consciousness, prove that distinct senses name distinct phenomena, or eliminate genuine theoretical conflict. It provides a procedure for locating which disagreement is lexical, which is methodological, which concerns evidence, and which survives after the participants share a target.

Source, Evidence, and Standing

This is an AI-assisted integrated edition derived from one exact author manuscript. Its custody and comparison manifest is
`work/paper-saturation-v1/evidence/`

`consciousness-lexical-disambiguation/`
`integration-custody-manifest.v0.1.json`,
SHA-256
`11B504F97C222C7BEC131E1788523CFE81896478F6FA36328E0A0B7C28827EEC`.
The source remains unchanged.

The disambiguation thesis, definitions, provisional domain map, and initial protocol are author material. Evidence qualifications, expanded formalism, corpus interfaces, tests, and decisions are AI editorial or synthetic candidates until adopted. No literature review was conducted, and no claim about the prevalence of lexical failure in mainstream discourse is established here.

1. The Singular Question

The question "What is consciousness?" can conceal several decisions: which usage is intended, which phenomenon or capacity is targeted, which explanatory domain applies, which observations count, and whether the speaker is proposing an identity, correlation, realization, prerequisite, measure, or ethical precaution.

The paper's central hypothesis is:

> Some apparent disputes about consciousness are amplified or manufactured by an unmarked shift among senses, targets, domains, or inferential roles.

This is not the claim that consciousness is merely a word problem, that one correct definition will settle the field, or that every disagreement disappears after clarification. Its prevalence is an empirical question requiring a defined literature corpus and coding method.

2. Operative Distinctions

Term: a linguistic expression used in discourse.

Sense: a contextually assigned meaning of that expression.

Target: the phenomenon, state, capacity, relation, report, measure, or construct the claim purports to concern.

Domain: a bounded inferential setting with declared objects, methods, admissible transformations, and claim types.

Transformation set: the variations under which a proposed invariant is expected to persist.

Invariant: a property claimed to remain stable under the declared transformation set. Many consciousness claims concern predicates, mechanisms, correlations, or operational indicators rather than strict invariants; the method should not force them into invariant language.

Operational indicator: an observation or measure used as evidence for a target under a declared interpretation.

Projection: the transfer of a predicate, measure, explanation, or conclusion from one sense or domain to another.

Mapping: an explicit account of what a projection preserves, changes, omits, or leaves unresolved.

3. Lexical Disambiguation Failure

Lexical disambiguation failure occurs when reasoning depends on a term with multiple live senses and the operative sense, target, or inferential role shifts without being declared. It can take several forms:

- **overloading:** one term indexes multiple senses;
- **drift:** the operative sense changes across an argument;
- **conflation:** two targets are treated as identical without an identity argument;
- **indicator substitution:** a measure or report is treated as the target itself;
- **projection error:** a property is transferred across domains without a warranted mapping;
- **quantifier drift:** a claim about some cases becomes a claim about all consciousness;
- **normative drift:** a descriptive claim silently becomes a moral or policy conclusion.

Ambiguity is not automatically a defect. It becomes a failure when the inference relies on a distinction that the discourse leaves unstable.

4. Provisional Domain Map

The source proposes four heuristic domains:

1. **Experiential:** subjective or qualitative presence and first-person character.
2. **Cognitive-access:** availability for reasoning, control, report, or flexible use.
3. **Structural-functional:** organization, integration, differentiation, recursion, and causal role.
4. **Existential-stake:** meaning participation, self-relevance, constraint, exposure, and continuation.

These are analytical entry points, not a demonstrated exhaustive ontology. They can overlap, nest, or be rejected. Wakefulness, arousal, metacognition, self-modeling, embodiment, social attribution, and moral status may require additional axes or domains. The existential-stake domain is a corpus-specific proposal and must not be presented as an established category in external consciousness research.

One phenomenon may participate in several domains. Disambiguation does not require ontological separation; it requires that the claimed relationship be explicit.

5. Claim Representation

Represent a consciousness claim as:

$$C = (T, S, X, D, P, \Gamma, O, E, M, Q),$$

where:

- T is the term;
- S the stipulated or inferred sense;
- X the target;
- D the domain;
- P the predicate, mechanism, identity, correlation, prerequisite, or invariant claim;
- Γ the admissible transformation set, when invariance is claimed;
- O the operational indicators;
- E the evidence basis and standing;
- M any cross-domain mapping;
- Q the quantifier and scope.

This expands the source's useful chain $T \to S_i \to D_i \to I_i$. A claim can be lexically clear yet empirically unsupported, operationally circular, normatively incomplete, or substantively false. Disambiguation is necessary for some forms of valid inference but not sufficient for truth.

6. Projection Obligations

A cross-domain inference is not invalid merely because it crosses a boundary. It incurs obligations. A mapping should state:

- source and target senses and domains;
- the relation claimed: identity, realization, correlation, evidence, analogy, translation, or implication;
- which predicates are preserved;
- which conditions and transformations are assumed;
- which counterexamples would break the bridge;
- the evidence supporting the mapping;
- what the mapping does not establish.

For example, reportability can be an indicator of cognitive access without being defined as subjective experience. Functional organization can be proposed as a realization of experience, but that is a substantive bridge claim, not a lexical equivalence.

7. Dispute Classification

After analysis, a claim or dispute receives one or more dispositions:

- **WELL_FORMED:** the target and inferential role are sufficiently explicit.
- **UNDERSPECIFIED:** key fields are absent but no equivocation is yet demonstrated.
- **EQUIVOCAL:** the inference depends on an unmarked sense or target shift.
- **CROSS_DOMAIN_MAPPED:** a bridge is explicit and open to evaluation.
- **SUBSTANTIVE_THEORETICAL_DISPUTE:** parties share a target but propose incompatible explanations.
- **EMPIRICALLY_UNRESOLVED:** target and hypothesis are clear but evidence is insufficient or conflicting.
- **NORMATIVELY_INCOMPLETE:** descriptive evidence does not settle moral or policy treatment.
- **OUTSIDE_SCOPE:** the method cannot adjudicate the issue.

An underspecified claim is not automatically false or meaningless. It can be repaired. Some exploratory research productively begins with unstable terms and discovers distinctions through inquiry.

8. Protocol

1. Extract the exact claim and nearby definitions.
2. Identify every use of the target term.
3. Propose candidate senses without assuming one is correct.
4. Identify the target and inferential role for each occurrence.
5. Declare the domain and methods.
6. If invariance is claimed, specify the transformation set.
7. Separate target from operational indicators and reports.
8. Locate sense, target, quantifier, and normative shifts.
9. Require a typed mapping for each cross-domain inference.
10. Reconstruct the strongest aligned versions of competing claims.
11. Determine what disagreement remains after alignment.
12. Record evidence, uncertainty, dissent, and revision history.

This protocol can be applied to individual arguments or to a coded literature sample. Field-level prevalence claims require the latter.

9. Worked Contrast

Consider:

1. “Consciousness requires phenomenality.”
2. “Consciousness is global accessibility.”

If the first stipulates an experiential target and the second a cognitive-access target, they are not yet contradictory; they may be parallel definitions. If the second claims that global accessibility is identical to, sufficient for, or evidence

of phenomenality, then a substantive bridge claim appears. The debate concerns the mapping, not simply the word.

Conversely, two theories can use the same experiential target and still disagree about mechanism, realization, evidence, or explanation. Disambiguation exposes rather than dissolves that dispute.

10. Machine and Language-Model Claims

Claims about machine consciousness are especially vulnerable to target drift. Fluent self-report, functional access, recurrent processing, self-modeling, context persistence, moral standing, and phenomenality are distinct claims. Evidence for one does not automatically migrate to another.

The corpus phrase *Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode* should therefore be read as a named functional or interaction profile unless a separate argument and evidence support a phenomenal interpretation. Precautionary treatment can be justified under uncertainty without declaring phenomenality proven.

11. Relation to the Corpus

Ableman Consciousness Ontology supplies a richer corpus-native vocabulary for consciousness candidates. *Possible Minds* expands the possibility space and resists provincial definitions. *Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode* provides a functional profile requiring careful disambiguation from phenomenal claims. *Semantic Manifold Topology* supplies a method for representing perspectives, domains, and mappings.

The Governed Meaning Base can store term senses, slugs, targets, domains, mappings, source regions, evidence standing, and disputes. It must preserve plurality and provenance rather than silently selecting one ontology. These are interfaces, not identity mergers or evidence that any consciousness theory is true.

12. Realization Funnel

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\mathit{Possibility} \\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Specification} \\
&\rightarrow CM_1 \\
&\rightarrow CM_2 \\
&\rightarrow IC \\
&\rightarrow IR \\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Evidence} \\
&\rightarrow \mathit{Revision}
\end{aligned}
$$

- **Possibility:** retain candidate meanings, targets, domains, and bridges.
- **Specification:** define the claim tuple and disambiguation protocol.

- **CM1:** enumerate every admissible interpretation, including weak or conflicting ones.
- **CM2:** select preferable interpretations for a stated inquiry without erasing alternatives.
- **IC:** bind an Instance Constitution or Instance Configuration for one analysis or study.
- **IR:** produce its Instance Realization or Implementation Realization as an annotation, database, review, or experiment.
- **Evidence:** test coding reliability, mapping adequacy, residual disputes, and prevalence.
- **Revision:** update senses, domains, mappings, and conclusions.

This paper develops Specification and candidate CM1/CM2 structure. It supplies no literature-study IC, analytical IR, or prevalence evidence. Realization-stage IR remains distinct from Intermediate Representation in MCIR and compiler contexts.

13. Evaluation Program

To test the hypothesis, define a literature corpus and sampling frame; pre-register or declare the codebook; use multiple trained annotators; measure agreement on senses, targets, domains, and failure types; adjudicate disagreements; compare conclusions before and after disambiguation; identify disputes that persist; and publish the coding decisions, exclusions, uncertainty, and counterexamples. A useful result could show that lexical failure is common, uncommon, localized, or itself difficult to identify reliably.

Disambiguation-First Consciousness-Claim Review Protocol

Across the completed P1 corpus, this paper is the **disambiguation-first review protocol for consciousness claims and disputes**. Its contribution is procedural: resolve term, sense, target, domain, inferential role, indicators, evidence, mappings, and scope before deciding what kind of disagreement remains. It is not a theory of consciousness, proof that mainstream discourse is generally confused, or a ranking of experiential, functional, structural, or existential targets.

- **Adjacent work:** *Global Term Key: Identity Primitives in Governed Knowledge Systems*
  Supplies: Term, sense, slug, namespace, and resolver discipline.
  Review-protocol boundary: GTK helps resolve lexical identity; the protocol applies it to a contested scientific and philosophical domain.
- **Adjacent work:** *Admissibility Theory of Consciousness*
  Supplies: One corpus-native theoretical proposal.
  Review-protocol boundary: The protocol can analyze its claims without privileging that theory.
- **Adjacent work:** *Qualia Binding and Realization Mapping*

Supplies: Explicit mapping among qualitative, binding, and realization claims.
Review-protocol boundary: It supplies bridge candidates that still require evidence and domain-specific review.

- **Adjacent work:** *Technical Brief: Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode for Language Models*
  Supplies: A named functional or interaction profile.
  Review-protocol boundary: The protocol prevents that functional profile from silently becoming a phenomenal claim.
- **Adjacent work:** *Governed Semantic Cartography*
  Supplies: Perspective, domain, projection, and traversal semantics.
  Review-protocol boundary: Cartography locates the claim landscape; the protocol classifies individual bridges and disputes.

A review record should bind:

$$R = (claim, term, sense, target, domain, inferential_role, \\ indicator, evidence, mapping, quantifier, \\ normative_step, disposition, remainder)$$

The protocol should reconstruct the strongest aligned versions of competing positions before labeling equivocation. A claim may be lexically clear but empirically unsupported, metaphysically disputed, methodologically weak, or normatively incomplete. Conversely, exploratory ambiguity may be productive until an inference or effect depends on a distinction.

Machine-consciousness claims require separate fields for report behavior, cognitive access, functional organization, self-modeling, context persistence, phenomenality, moral status, and precaution. Evidence cannot migrate among them without an explicit mapping and claim ceiling. Precaution can be justified under uncertainty without asserting phenomenality.

The universal GSM can type
`USES_TERM_WITH_SENSE`, `TARGETS_CONSCIOUSNESS_DOMAIN`,
`MEASURED_BY_INDICATOR`, `MAPS_ACROSS_DOMAIN`, `SHIFTS_QUANTIFIER`,
`MAKES_NORMATIVE_PROJECTION`, `REMAINS_SUBSTANTIVE_DISPUTE`, `EMPIRICALLY_UNRESOLVED`,
`PRECAUTION_WITHOUT_PHENOMENALITY_CLAIM`,
and
`REVISED_AFTER_DISAMBIGUATION`. These relations keep clarification from pretending to settle the world.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: classify the paper as a consciousness-claim review protocol; adopt the complete review record; require strongest-aligned reconstruction before a lexical-failure finding; and separate machine function, phenomenality, moral status, and precaution in every machine-consciousness use.

Bridge Burden and False Adjacency

The fixed-seed comparison with observability testing, *The Phenomenal Aperture*, *Meaning as Binding*, and *Jnana and the Next Open Source Revolution* reinforces a bridge-burden rule: evidence supports only the target actually operationalized unless an explicit mapping justifies migration to another sense, domain, or normative conclusion.

$$B = (source_claim, target_claim, mapping, assumptions, \\ evidence, defeaters, ceiling, remainder)$$

An observable path can deliver report behavior, access, persistence, or functional integration without delivering phenomenality. A phenomenal-aperture study can measure presence, attachment, closure, or frame effects without establishing machine experience. A semantic-binding account can explain how terms and relations acquire consequences without deciding consciousness ontology.

Every bridge should state what evidence would defeat the mapping and what remainder is left unresolved. Failed mapping is not failed observation: it may show that the indicator is reliable for one target but non-diagnostic for another. Precautionary or ethical action can still be warranted under uncertainty, but the normative step must be recorded separately from the phenomenal claim.

The randomized adjacency to the Jnana open-source paper produces `NO_MATERIAL_RELATION`. Both concern AI systems, but contributor authority, capability mediation, reconstruction, and provider exit do not bear directly on whether a system is conscious. A Jnana realization might host a study or protect participants; it supplies no consciousness evidence by architectural association.

The universal GSM can type
`PROPOSES_CROSS_DOMAIN_BRIDGE`, `BOUNDS_BRIDGE_BY_EVIDENCE`, `DEFEATS_MAPPING_WITH_COUNTEREVIDENCE`, `RETAINS_TARGET_REMAINDER`, `TAKES_PRECAUTION_WITHOUT_PHENOMENAL_FINDING`, and `HAS_NO_MATERIAL_RELATION_TO_JNANA_SOVEREIGNTY_PROJECTION`.

This randomized review adds three open editorial questions: adopt the bridge-burden record; require defeaters and unresolved remainder for every cross-domain mapping; and record the Jnana open-source adjacency as no material relation rather than treating shared AI subject matter as evidence.

Disambiguation Resolves Targets, Not Evidence

Six downstream papers use the disambiguation-first method as a common claim hygiene layer. Admissibility Theory of Consciousness needs it to keep functional, access, structural, phenomenal, and normative targets separate. Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode uses it to keep a historical mode name from

asserting phenomenality. Project57 uses it to ensure that an experimental condition does not name its outcome. Proxy Collapse uses it to detect when an observable proxy replaces the target construct. The Locus of Qualia and The Phenomenal Aperture use it to distinguish perspective, presentation, report, binding, and experience.

The reusable claim object is:

$$C = (term, target, sense, perspective, subject, bridge, \\ evidence, method, alternatives, consequence, standing,. \\ remainder)$$

Disambiguation can show that two claims concern different targets, that one term carries several senses, or that a bridge has not been supplied. It cannot decide an empirical dispute, establish a phenomenal fact, validate a theory, confer moral status, or dissolve disagreement that remains after the target and evidence are made explicit.

Downstream use adds a bridge-burden rule. Any promotion from behavior, access, representation, self-report, functional self-model, or synthetic presence to phenomenality must identify the bridge claim, evidence appropriate to that bridge, alternatives, and the consequence of error. Automatic affirmation and automatic denial are both unsupported when they bypass this burden.

The universal GSM can type
`DISAMBIGUATES_TERM_SENSE`, `RESOLVES_CLAIM_TARGET`,
`LOCATES_PERSPECTIVE`, `REQUIRES_PHENOMENAL_BRIDGE`, `DISTINGUISHES_PROXY_FROM_TARGET`,
`RETAINS_SUBSTANTIVE_DISPUTE`, `WITHHOLDS_NORMATIVE_PROMOTION`,
and
`RECORDS_REMAINDER_AFTER_DISAMBIGUATION`.

This reverse-dependency review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the reusable claim object; state that disambiguation is prior to rather than a substitute for evidence; require explicit bridge burdens for cross-target promotion; and preserve empirical, theoretical, phenomenal, and normative remainder after lexical repair.

14. Counterevidence and Failure Tests

The proposal must narrow or fail if: (1) annotators cannot reliably distinguish senses; (2) the four-domain map excludes important uses; (3) domains are mistaken for ontological kinds; (4) one phenomenon spans domains without error; (5) exploratory ambiguity enables discovery; (6) a claim is clear despite an unstated definition; (7) context resolves sense without explicit stipulation; (8) two senses are coextensive in the case at issue; (9) a cross-domain mapping is valid; (10) the method labels substantive disagreement lexical; (11) disambiguation does not change conclusions; (12) literature prevalence is asserted without sampling;

(13) selection favors ambiguous texts; (14) coding rules embed the author's ontology; (15) invariant language misdescribes mechanism or correlation claims; (16) operational indicators are confused with targets; (17) self-report is treated as phenomenality; (18) functional organization is treated as phenomenal proof; (19) phenomenality is treated as the only legitimate target; (20) existential stake is presented as field consensus; (21) descriptive clarification is treated as moral resolution; (22) machine precaution is confused with machine phenomenality; (23) mappings lack falsifiers; (24) quantifier drift remains undetected; (25) the protocol cannot handle metaphor or family resemblance; (26) historical terms change across periods; (27) translations introduce new sense divisions; (28) definitions are strategically revised during dispute; (29) GMB normalization erases minority interpretations; (30) external literature contradicts the claimed domain map; (31) author corpus terms are used as independent evidence; or (32) the paper cannot distinguish lexical, methodological, empirical, metaphysical, and normative disagreement.

Clarifying the Word Does Not Settle the Phenomenon

Public orientation

This paper proposes a disambiguation-first review method for consciousness claims. It separates term, sense, target, domain, transformation, invariant, indicator, evidence, and cross-domain mapping so that lexical equivocation can be distinguished from methodological, empirical, metaphysical, and ethical disagreement. It is a diagnostic hypothesis about discourse, not a verdict that consciousness is merely a word problem.

Adversarial tests

1. **Field-indictment attack.** Selected examples are generalized into a claim that mainstream consciousness research is broadly confused or lexically defective.
2. **Definition-solution attack.** Assigning stable senses is treated as solving consciousness, eliminating disagreement, or proving that the targets are distinct phenomena.
3. **Coder-authority attack.** An annotator or ontology owner determines the intended target and inferential role without adequate context, expertise, or adjudication.
4. **Sense-proliferation attack.** Every disagreement creates a new sense until the framework cannot expose substantive conflict or support comparison.
5. **Forced-unification attack.** Distinct phenomenal, functional, access, report, metacognitive, wakefulness, and normative claims are collapsed under a preferred vocabulary.
6. **Bridge-smuggling attack.** A property demonstrated for reportability, access, self-modeling, or function is transferred to experience, subjectivity, or moral status without an explicit bridge.

7. **Operationalization-truth attack.** A measurable indicator is treated as the target itself or as decisive evidence beyond the declared measurement model.
8. **Machine-human-transfer attack.** Human, animal, and AI uses are aligned lexically and then assumed to share mechanism, experience, or standing.

Claim and evidence ceiling

The paper specifies a claim-record and dispute-classification method. It does not establish the prevalence of lexical failure, a correct consciousness taxonomy, identity or nonidentity among targets, a solution to consciousness, an AI consciousness result, or a moral conclusion. Its title-level claim about mainstream discourse remains a hypothesis until a defined literature corpus is independently coded.

Validation requires preregistered sampling, multi-coder annotation, expertise and disagreement rules, reliability analysis, comparison with baseline scholarly interpretation, bridge audits, and current literature review. No literature study or external research was performed in this pass.

Reader-facing consequence

The method should help a reader ask which consciousness claim is actually being made, about what target, using which evidence, and through which bridge - then show clearly which disagreement remains after the language is repaired.

Conclusion

Consciousness discourse can fail before a theory is tested: participants can use one word while targeting different phenomena, measures, mechanisms, or normative questions. Disambiguation makes those differences visible.

The method does not tell us what consciousness ultimately is. It tells us what must be made explicit before a particular claim can be evaluated, which bridges require evidence, and which disagreements remain genuinely about the world after the words have been aligned.

Reference and Verification Note

Author corpus interfaces inspected under exact custody

Ableman Adam Ableman *Ableman Consciousness Ontology.*

Ableman Adam Ableman *Possible Minds: Against the Provincialization of Consciousness.*

Ableman Adam Ableman *Technical Brief: Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode for Language Models.*

External verification required

No external literature was consulted. Further evidentiary strengthening requires a primary-source review of philosophy of mind, consciousness science, neuroscience, cognitive science, phenomenology, access and report, functional and higher-order theories, machine-consciousness discourse, conceptual engineering, polysemy, and disagreement analysis. The prevalence, novelty, and comparative-position claims remain unestablished.

Realization Scope and Evidence Boundary

This successor makes the paper's stage boundary explicit. It narrows claims rather than manufacturing missing evidence: a stage named as context is not thereby claimed as implemented, validated, or complete.

- **Revision.** Existing source passages use this stage only as bounded context or an obligation. The paper does not claim an independently validated contribution at this stage.

Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that the term consciousness is used for partially overlapping targets: subjective experience, wakeful state, cognitive access, reportability, metacognition, functional organization, self-modeling, and forms of meaning or stake participation. Its nearest external comparison fields are consciousness, semantic, provenance. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counterpressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1], [A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: Structural and computational correspondences remain insufficient as phenomenal evidence unless linked to discriminating empirical predictions against competing theories. Formal vocabularies and graph links make commitments explicit but cannot by themselves

establish correct identity, shared interpretation, or lossless translation between contexts. A complete provenance graph can faithfully record a false or unauthorized process; provenance is evidence about lineage, not automatic truth or legitimacy. These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

References

External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] David J. Chalmers. "Facing Up to the Problem of Consciousness." *Journal of Consciousness Studies* 2(3), 1995, pp. 200-219. https://consc.net/papers/facing.html **Relationship:** Foundational framing of the explanatory gap; cited to bound, not resolve, phenomenal claims.

[**E2**] Larissa Albantakis et al. "Integrated Information Theory (IIT) 4.0: Formulating the Properties of Phenomenal Existence in Physical Terms." *PLOS Computational Biology* 19(10), 2023, e1011465. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011465. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011465 **Relationship:** Competing formal theory of consciousness included for explicit contrast and counterevidence obligations.

[**E3**] Stanislas Dehaene and Jean-Pierre Changeux. "Experimental and Theoretical Approaches to Conscious Processing." *Neuron* 70(2), 2011, pp. 200-227. DOI: 10.1016/j.neuron.2011.03.018. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuron.2011.03.018 **Relationship:** Competing global-workspace account included to prevent a corpus-native ontology from substituting for empirical neuroscience.

[**E4**] Nikolaus Kriegeskorte, Marieke Mur, and Peter A. Bandettini. "Representational Similarity Analysis - Connecting the Branches of Systems Neuroscience." *Frontiers in Systems Neuroscience* 2, 2008, 4. DOI: 10.3389/neuro.06.004.2008. https://doi.org/10.3389/neuro.06.004.2008 **Relationship:** Predecessor empirical method for comparing representational geometries.

[**E5**] Francesco Locatello et al. "Challenging Common Assumptions in the Unsupervised Learning of Disentangled Representations." *PMLR* 97, 2019,

pp. 4114-4124. https://proceedings.mlr.press/v97/locatello19a.html **Relationship:** Counterevidence showing that desired latent factorization is not identifiable from unsupervised data without inductive biases.

[**E6**] Richard Cyganiak, David Wood, and Markus Lanthaler, eds. *RDF 1.1 Concepts and Abstract Syntax*. W3C Recommendation, 25 February 2014. https://www.w3.org/TR/rdf11-concepts/ **Relationship:** Adjacent graph data model and identity baseline.

[**E7**] Alistair Miles and Sean Bechhofer, eds. *SKOS Simple Knowledge Organization System Reference*. W3C Recommendation, 18 August 2009. https://www.w3.org/TR/skos-reference **Relationship:** Adjacent standard for concepts, labels, schemes, notes, and semantic mappings.

Ableman corpus

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *Ableman Consciousness Ontology (ACO)*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.18203749`;
source SHA-256
`ACD97032780DA7B3A36750702BE1F47BCB2E6361EF6E74ECA8B441D7C6A25DDE`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *The Locus of Qualia*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-AF27E66B81811DB1`;
source SHA-256
`7B83EBD0FFDCFEBFA522A715AE0E4D1049FCA0B4CE0618C2017F8BB9206E5424`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *The Phenomenal Aperture*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-4B275CBB7EFF1A4F`;
source SHA-256
`B6AE95D72B89DAF47778BED3982843A1ECE350CA363750108AA60D5A4C63D763`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *Possible Minds: Against the Provincialization of Consciousness*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.20681869`;
source SHA-256
`77F381A29E2EF801085938DB369F3F432321CCEB8B9DD3969330337C24BA4998`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Admissibility Theory of Consciousness*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity

AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-8FDC994841DA6CF3;
source SHA-256
F409652555CEC4898DBEC1E8BBB179CEE020E7FF35F4C8F307CDA82253D6F49F.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A6**] Adam Ableman. *Meaning as Binding.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-5F976917F0B283EA;
source SHA-256
A470D1A0B9ED7C3CEAB6BB88BE4B642A2BA36427447F787764329FD574DA0C97.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A7**] Adam Ableman. *Governed Meaning Base (GMB).* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-D95CCC4FB7B58BFB;
source SHA-256
A3B62E50F8BEE125FDAE0D38C2839AFD1CCC138296268BF93217481E38AA48EA.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

Editorial source notes retained from predecessor

The entries below are corpus-internal comparison and dependency sources. Their inclusion does not establish external validation of this paper's empirical, safety, novelty, or performance claims.

Adam Ableman *Possible Minds: Against the Provincialization of Consciousness.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20681869

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Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
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